

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Great Black One that Liberates from All Epidemic Diseases

Toh 669 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ནག་པོ་ཚེ་པའི་གཞུང་རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ནང་ཐམས་ཅད་ལས་ཐར་བར་བརྟེན།

Toh 669 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as "Phags pa nag po chen po'i gzungs rims nad thams cad las thar bar byed pa," translated into English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Great Black One that Liberates from All Epidemic Diseases," with the deity at its center known in Sanskrit as Mahākāla. This short ritual text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of the Kangyur and centers on the wrathful protective deity Mahākāla, described as dark and yellow with sharp fangs, invoked specifically for protection against epidemic illness. The text consists primarily of a dhāraṇī formula to be recited while directing one's gaze in various directions, commanding the release of disease from every part of the body through a series of imperative mantric phrases addressed to the afflicting forces. It sits within the broader collection of dhāraṇī and mantra literature preserved in the Kangyur, reflecting the tradition of employing the power of wrathful bodhisattva-protectors for healing and apotropaic purposes.

The noble dhāraṇī called "The Glorious Protector, the Black One" is complete.

The noble dhāraṇī of the Great Black One that liberates from all epidemic diseases.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The Great Black One, a being dark and yellow, with sharp fangs, with great fangs, who liberates from all epidemic diseases — this is to be recited:

In whatever direction one looks, may I be free from epidemic disease in that very place.

Thus:

Hana hana rāja dhūtena. Daha daha rāja dhūtena. Paca paca pārāja dhūtena. Bahuśrave. Bahuparimṭpāri. Bahuparishodhane. Imaṃ jāra caṇḍalaṃ. Hana hana. Oṃ sumbha ni sumbha śira muñca. Cakṣu muñca. Śrotra muñca. Ghrāṇa muñca. Jihvā muñca. Kaṇṭha muñca. Grīva muñca. Preṣṭha muñca. Kāṭikā muñca. Kuṅṣi muñca. Ūru muñca. Jānou muñca. Hasta muñca. Pādou muñca. Aṃguli muñca. Aṃgapratyaṃga muñca. Apasara anyasīma muñca. Gaccha. Jvara muto si mama svāhā. Oṃ jvala mā aṃguli hūṃ. Sarva jvarānan phaṭ.

The noble dhāraṇī of the Great Black One that liberates from all epidemic diseases is complete.

Translated and revised by the Indian scholar Prajñāvarman and the great translator monk Yeshé Dé, and established as a definitive version.

Translator's Notes

- The epithet "Nag po chen po" rendered here as "the Great Black One" refers to Mahākāla, the wrathful dharma protector. The text does not gloss it with Śiva; in this dhāraṇī context it designates the protector deity Mahākāla specifically, distinct from the Śiva identification that can accompany the title in other contexts.

The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic renderings and reconstructed into standard Sanskrit orthography as faithfully as possible. Some syllables, particularly "pārāja" in the third dhūtena phrase and "preṣṭha" (rendered from "preshtha"), represent the translator's best reading of slightly irregular Tibetan phonetic notation. The phrase "jvara muto si mama" likely corresponds to Sanskrit "jvara mukto 'si mama," meaning "fever, you are released from me," which fits the dhāraṇī's therapeutic intent perfectly.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.